21번

We are now at a point of unprecedented genetic, cultural, and environmental power as a species, and we are linked to nearly every other person on Earth.

We are embodied individuals trapped within limited time, but we are also networked data streams, memories, and influencers, and part of a grander humanity.

Our decisions today have far-reaching impacts that place a responsibility on us to become good ancestors, to take the long view and time travel forward to imagine the well-being of billions of people whose lives will be lived in the world we are currently making.

Centuries ago, leaders of the native North American Iroquois people created "seven generation stewardship," instructing people to consider the impact of every decision on their children, seven generations into the future.

In the precious few decades that Earth is ours, while we enjoy the gardens planted by our ancestors, we must not steal the shade from our descendants.

24번

Habits aren't bad.

We need them to survive.

Understanding how the brain uses habits, and how you can work with them, is essential for business.

One question to ask is, are you really trying to break a habit, or would you do better by attaching to another one (known as temptation bundling)?

Wharton professor Katy Milkman led a research project called Holding the Hunger Games Hostage at the Gym, where participants could only have access to their audio devices while at the gym.

This uses a tempting habit — listening to that awesome audiobook — and combines it with a habit people would like to build, but may otherwise feel forced to put off, like exercising.

The participants whose devices were "held hostage" were 51 percent more likely to visit the gym.

And the really amazing thing is what happened after it was over: nearly two-thirds opted to pay to have gym-only access for their devices!

29번

A conceptual model is an explanation, usually highly simplified, of how something works.

It doesn't have to be complete or even accurate as long as it is useful.

The files, folders, and icons you see displayed on a computer screen help people create the conceptual model of documents and folders inside the computer, or of apps or applications on the screen.

In fact, there are no folders inside the computer — those are effective conceptualizations designed to make them easier to use.

Sometimes these depictions can add to the confusion, however.

When reading e-mail or visiting a website, the material appears to be on the device, for that is where it is displayed and used.

But in fact, in many cases the actual material is "in the cloud," located on some distant machine.

The conceptual model is of one, coherent image, whereas it may actually consist of parts, each located on different machines that could be almost anywhere in the world.

30번

The principal transportation mode in the developing world, even in large cities, is still walking because of constraints on the resources needed to operate extensive transit systems.

People cover long distances on foot every day and expend human energy that they can hardly spare.

Walking under those conditions is an unavoidable burden that consumes productive capability.

In North America and Western Europe, however, the attitude and policies are just the opposite: walking is efficient, healthful, and natural.

We should do more of it — almost everybody agrees — and some of the current trends should be reversed.

Ironically, among the most popular exercise machines in health clubs and in homes are tread-mills that simulate walking, which could be otherwise accomplished with a transport purpose on the street.

31번

Just like how other rooms in your home can cause anxiety when filled with too much stuff, the same is true for kids.

If the play space houses every single toy that has ever been purchased for them since birth, they may not be able to express their feelings, but they can feel overwhelmed by so much stuff.

This reminds us of how women look in their closets packed full of clothes and think, I have nothing to wear.

Revision helps everyone see what they have and use what they own.

When there's too much to see, too much to step over, and too much input, kids have a hard time making a choice.

Streamlining a play space is so important.

You want your kids to feel inspired and imaginative in the room — not overcome with indecision.

32번

Students often mistake familiarity with true mastery, creating a dangerous "illusion of competence" where recognizing information feels like genuine knowledge, but they struggle when asked to recall or apply it independently.

This cognitive bias, strengthened by passive study methods, leads learners to overestimate their understanding.

Teaching materials (even informally or imaginatively) actively counters this illusion by requiring deep processing, active recall, structured organization, and revealing gaps in knowledge.

It introduces powerful methods like teaching imaginary students, peer-teaching in study groups, employing the Feynman Technique, and writing explanations for others.

Ultimately, adopting the teacher mindset transforms surface familiarity into real mastery, exposing and filling gaps in knowledge and ensuring solid, reliable understanding.

33번

From around 3000 BC, the Sumerian officials would mark their lists of goods on clay tablets.

If they wanted to record five fish, they would mark five pictures of a fish.

Their first great intellectual leap came from separating the number from the object they were counting.

In other words, they would represent five fish with a numeral for the number five alongside a symbol for the fish.

If they wanted to describe five of something else, they realized they could keep the same numeral and trade the object symbol for a cow, or a jar of oil, or whatever else they were interested in.

The Sumerians had developed the idea of an emancipated number, existing in its own right and independent of whatever it is being used to count.

It is easy to take the emancipated number for granted as it is so deeply set into modern thought, but to the earliest civilizations it was intellectually new and extremely powerful.

34번

The emphasis on learning from the ingroup takes little account of individuals.

Amazingly, while we may dislike some of the people in our ingroup, we still copy them.

Wilks, Kirby, and Nielsen studied copying behavior in the context of observing how to open a puzzle box.

Ingroups and outgroups were distinguished in a minimal way, using simple color coding of wristbands.

The children did not simply like all members of their ingroup; they disliked those who behaved in an antisocial fashion.

Indeed, they liked these antisocial ingroup members less than the prosocial members of an outgroup.

Still, their dislike did not affect their tendency to copy ingroup behavior more closely than outgroup behavior.

This overimitation reveals that we are not copying in order to learn how to open a box most efficiently.

We want to learn how to do it in the proper way — in other words, conforming to the rules and conventions of the ingroup.

This will be appropriately demonstrated even by antisocial ingroup members.

38번

As Kuhn proposed, our propositions about the world are embedded within paradigms, roughly a network of interrelated commitments to a particular theory, a conception of a subject matter, and methodological practices.

Thus, when scientists undertake research, they do so from within a specific paradigm.

Even the most exacting measurements are only sensible from within that paradigm.

For example, a look into a microscope tells you nothing unless you are already informed about the nature of the instrument and what you are supposed to be looking at.

Thus, what we call major progress in science is not a movement from a less to a more accurate paradigm.

Rather, it is a horizontal shift from one 'way of seeing the world' to another.

For Kuhn, 'the scientist with a new paradigm sees differently from the way he had seen before.'

41~42번

It's fair to say that patience has a terrible name.

For one thing, the prospect of doing anything that you've been told will require patience simply seems unattractive.

More specifically, though, it's disturbingly passive.

It is the virtue that has traditionally been urged upon housewives, while their husbands led more exciting lives outside the home; or on racial minorities, told to wait just a few more decades for their full civil rights.

The talented but self-effacing employee who "waits patiently" for a promotion, we tend to feel, will be waiting a long time: she ought to be trumpeting her achievements instead.

In all such cases, patience is a way of psychologically accommodating yourself to a lack of power, an attitude intended to help you to resign yourself to your lowly position, in theoretical hopes of better days to come.

But as society accelerates, something shifts.

In more and more contexts, patience becomes a form of power.

In a world geared for hurry, the capacity to resist the urge to hurry — to allow things to take the time they take — is a way to gain purchase on the world, to do the work that counts, and to derive satisfaction from the doing itself, instead of putting off all your fulfillment to the future.